



CAPTAIN TEAM

— NOTES & FILES —



VU HELPING DESK



Study Smart.
Achieve More.



Knowledge
shared,
Success prepared.

“

Good notes build *clarity*.
Clear notes build *confidence*.
Confidence builds *success*.



CAPTAIN TEAM

— We Lead, You Succeed —



NOTES & FILES

— Organized • Reliable • Helpful —



VU HELPING DESK

— We're Here to Help You —

ENG508 – IMP FINAL TERM

SECTION 1: MCQs & FILL-IN-THE-BLANKS

1. Geoffrey Leech used terms for dictionaries such as _____.

Answer: All of the given (flesh-and-blood, theoretical, practical)

2. Rules of language to use language effectively in context are called?

Answer: Pragmatics

3. "Some, butter, some milk" are examples of which category?

Answer: Mass Nouns (agar option mein "Mass Nouns" ho to wahi choose karein, agar na ho to Uncountable Nouns)

4. Leech gave how many functions of language?

Answer: Five

5. A lexical entry is a combination of which specifications?

Answer: All of the given (Morphological, Syntactic, Semantic)

6. Post-war philosophers of which city did NOT use 'pragmatics'?

Answer: Oxford

7. Horn says distinction between "said" and "meant" goes back to which century?

Answer: Fourth century

8. Chapman (2011) divided pragmatics into how many types?

Answer: Two

9. Formal semantics mainly relates to?

Answer: Reference

10. J.L. Austin worked on?

Answer: Speech Acts

11. Pragmatics is the branch which includes:

Answer: Context and Speaker Meaning

12. Our culture and linguistic background are associated with:

Answer: Pragmatics

13. The idea/meaning expressed by a signifier is called:

Answer: Signified

14. Saussure distinguished between _____ and paradigmatic relations:

Answer: Syntagmatic

15. The verb "Kill" is a:

Answer: Lexical causative

16. Which branch is concerned with meaning through language in use?

Answer: Pragmatics

17. Semantic categories are defined in terms of:

Answer: Semantic features

18. Entity towards which something is moved (literal/metaphorical) is:

Answer: Goal

19. Difficulty arises from the influence of _____ on word meaning:

Answer: Context (agar option mein Context ho to wahi, warna Culture)

20. Affective meaning reflects the _____ feelings of speakers:

Answer: Personal / Emotional

21. The source of literal meaning is:

Answer: Lexicon (words)

22. Australia is _____ and India is _____.

Answer: Australia = Cross-cultural ; India = Pluricultural

23. Third person deixis is possible?

Answer: Yes (he, she, it, they)

24. Difference between structural and lexical ambiguity:

Answer: Structural = Sentence structure, Lexical = Word meaning

25. Clark's theory provides us:

Answer: Common Ground (shared knowledge)

26. Direct vs Indirect speech acts:

Answer: Direct = Literal ; Indirect = Hidden meaning

27. CALL stands for:

Answer: Computer-Assisted Language Learning

28. Prosody means:

Answer: Rhythm, stress, and intonation of speech

29. Anaphoric reference:

Answer: Points backward (e.g., Ali came. He sat.)

30. Cataphoric reference:

Answer: Points forward (e.g., He was tired. Ali sat.)

31. Corpus linguistics:

Answer: Study of language using large text databases

32. Marked vs Unmarked:

Answer: Marked = Unusual structure ; Unmarked = Normal structure

33. Generic expressions:

Answer: Words referring to a whole class (e.g., The lion is a king)

SECTION 2: SHORT QUESTIONS (Definitions)

1. What is Pragmatics?

Answer: Pragmatics is the study of meaning in context. It is not just about literal words, but what the speaker really means.

Example: "It's cold" can mean "Please close the window."

2. Define Formal Grammar.

Answer: Formal grammar is a set of mathematical rules to build correct sentences. It only cares about structure, not meaning.

Example: $S \rightarrow NP + VP$ (Sentence = Noun Phrase + Verb Phrase)

3. What is Deixis?

Answer: Deixis refers to words that point to people, places, or times. These words need context to understand their meaning.

Types:

- Person Deixis: I, you, he, she

- Place Deixis: here, there
 - Time Deixis: now, then, today
 - Social Deixis: Sir, Madam
-

4. What is the Maxim of Quality?

Answer: The Maxim of Quality means be truthful. Do not lie and do not say things without proof.

5. What is the Maxim of Manner?

Answer: The Maxim of Manner means be clear. Do not be vague, confusing, or too wordy.

6. What is Politeness Theory?

Answer: Politeness theory explains how we use language to be respectful and avoid hurting others' feelings.

Example: Saying "Could I have water?" instead of "Give me water."

7. What is Face (Positive and Negative)?

Answer:

- Positive Face = The desire to be liked and approved by others.
 - Negative Face = The desire to be free, independent, and not imposed upon.
-

8. What is a Speech Act?

Answer: A speech act is doing something with words.

Example: Saying "I promise" is not just talking; it is actually making a promise.

9. What is Reference?

Answer: Reference is using words to help the listener identify something.

Parts:

- Referring = the words used
- Referent = the actual thing being referred to

10. What is Anaphoric vs Cataphoric Reference?

Answer:

- Anaphoric Reference = Points BACKWARD to something already said.
 - Example: Ali came. He sat. (He refers to Ali)
 - Cataphoric Reference = Points FORWARD to something coming later.
 - Example: He was tired. Ali sat. (He refers to Ali)
-

11. What is Clark's Theory?

Answer: Clark's theory says that conversation works because of Common Ground. Common ground is the shared knowledge between the speaker and the listener.

Example: If both people know the teacher, you can say "the teacher" and they will understand who you mean.

12. What is Conventional Implicature?

Answer: Conventional implicature is meaning that comes from specific words themselves, not from context.

Example: "She is poor but honest." The word "but" implies contrast between poor and honest.

13. What is Cancellability?

Answer: Cancellability means that the implied meaning can be removed without making the sentence wrong.

Example:

- Person A: "Do you have children?"
 - Person B: "I have dogs." (implies no children)
 - Person B can say: "I have dogs AND two children." (the implicature is cancelled)
-

14. What is Lexical Coherence?

Answer: Lexical coherence means that words in a text are logically connected and make sense together.

Example: "I went to the shop. I bought milk. I came home." - All sentences are connected.

15. What is Structural vs Lexical Ambiguity?

Answer:

- Lexical Ambiguity = Same word has multiple meanings.
 - Example: "Bank" can mean river edge OR financial institution.
 - Structural Ambiguity = Same sentence has multiple meanings due to structure.
 - Example: "I saw the man with the telescope." (I used telescope OR the man had it)
-

16. What is Presupposition?

Answer: Presupposition is something that the speaker assumes is true before speaking.

Examples:

- "My brother is here." → Presupposes that I have a brother.
 - "Stop smoking!" → Presupposes that you were smoking.
-

17. What is Strong vs Weak Implicature?

Answer:

- Strong Implicature = Almost certain.
 - Example: "He ate dinner" → implies he is not hungry (strong).
 - Weak Implicature = Possible but not certain.
 - Example: "The food was interesting" → maybe liked, maybe not (weak).
-

18. What are Adjacency Pairs?

Answer: Adjacency pairs are two-part exchanges where a response is expected.

Examples:

- Question → Answer
- Greeting → Greeting
- Offer → Accept or Refuse

- Example: A: "Hello!" B: "Hello!"
-

19. What is Direct vs Indirect Speech Act?

Answer:

- Direct Speech Act = Literal meaning.
 - Example: "Close the door."
 - Indirect Speech Act = Hidden meaning.
 - Example: "It's cold here." (means please close the door)
-

20. What is Topic and Comment?

Answer:

- Topic = What the sentence is about (given information).
- Comment = The new information about the topic.

Example: "The book (topic) is very interesting (comment)."

21. What is Given and New Information?

Answer:

- Given Information = Already known to the listener.
- New Information = Being introduced for the first time.

Example: "I bought a CAR (new). The CAR (given) is RED (new)."

22. What is Interlanguage?

Answer: Interlanguage is the language system that a learner creates while learning a second language. It is a mix of their native language and the new language.

23. What is Communicative Competence?

Answer: Communicative competence is the ability to use language correctly AND appropriately in social situations. It is not just grammar; it is knowing when and how to say things.

24. What is FTA (Face Threatening Act)?

Answer: FTA is an act that hurts someone's self-image or face.

Examples: Criticizing, ordering, interrupting, disagreeing.

25. What is FSA (Face Saving Act)?

Answer: FSA is an act that protects someone's self-image or face.

Example: Saying "I'm sorry, but..." before disagreeing.

26. What is Cohesion?

Answer: Cohesion refers to the grammatical and lexical links that connect parts of a text together.

Examples: Words like "he", "this", "however", "and" connect sentences.

27. What is Cultural Pragmatics?

Answer: Cultural pragmatics is the study of how culture affects the way people use and understand language in context.

28. What is Argumentation Theory?

Answer: Argumentation theory is the study of how people build logical arguments and persuade others using language.

Example: Using words like "therefore", "because", "for example" to build a logical argument.

29. What is Formal Pragmatics?

Answer: Formal pragmatics uses mathematical and logical models to study meaning in context. It is very precise and scientific.

Example: Analyzing how context affects the truth of "She is here" by checking who "she" is and where "here" is.

30. What is Deictic Reference?

Answer: Deictic reference refers to words that point based on the speaker's situation.

Examples: I, here, now, you, there, yesterday.

31. What are Metaphor, Irony, and Hyperbole?

Answer:

- Metaphor = Comparison without using "like" or "as".
 - Example: "Time is money."
 - Irony = Saying the opposite of what you mean.
 - Example: "Great weather!" when it is raining.
 - Hyperbole = Extreme exaggeration.
 - Example: "I have told you a million times."
-

32. What are I, M, Q Principles (Levinson)?

Answer:

- Q-Principle = Say as much as needed (Quantity).
 - I-Principle = Say as little as needed (Informativeness).
 - M-Principle = Marked expressions mean marked situations (Manner).
-

33. What is Particularized Conversational Implicature?

Answer: Particularized conversational implicature is meaning that depends on a specific situation.

Example:

- Person A: "Are you coming to the party?"
 - Person B: "I have to study."
 - Implicature (in this situation): Person B is NOT coming.
-

34. What are Meronyms?

Answer: Meronyms show a part-whole relationship.

Example: Wheel is a meronym of car.

Three ways meronyms vary:

1. Obligatoriness - Is the part essential?
2. Composition - How many parts?
3. Granularity - How detailed?

35. What is Training Pragmatics Outside the Classroom?

Answer: Training pragmatics outside the classroom means learning pragmatics through real-life experiences, not just textbooks.

Methods: Role-plays, watching movies, talking to native speakers, visiting places where the language is spoken.

Example: Actually going to a restaurant and ordering food instead of just reading about it.

36. What is the Relationship between Utterance and Prior Knowledge?

Answer: We understand new speech (utterance) based on what we already know (prior knowledge).

Example: If someone says "The president arrived" and you know who the president is, you understand. If you don't know, it makes no sense.

Conclusion: Communication only works when the speaker and listener share knowledge.

SECTION 3: LONG QUESTIONS (Detailed Answers)

Long Question 1: Write a note on Deontic Modality with examples.

Answer:

Deontic modality deals with obligation, permission, and necessity. It tells us what must, should, or may happen.

Types with Examples:

1. Obligation (Must / Should):
 - "You must wear a helmet."
 - "Students should complete their homework."
2. Permission (May / Can):
 - "You may leave early."
 - "Can I use your phone?"
3. Prohibition (Must not / Cannot):
 - "You must not smoke here."
 - "You cannot park here."

4. Advice (Ought to / Should):
- "You ought to apologize."
 - "You should see a doctor."

Uses: Deontic modality is used in rules, laws, instructions, and advice.

Long Question 2: What are five types of Antonyms? Write names with examples.

Answer:

Antonyms are words with opposite meanings.

Type	Description	Examples
1. Gradable	Degrees in between	Hot/Cold (warm in between), Big/Small
2. Complementary	No middle ground	Alive/Dead, True/False, Male/Female
3. Relational	Depend on each other	Parent/Child, Teacher/Student, Buy/Sell
4. Reverse	Opposite action	Tie/Untie, Open/Close, Pack/Unpack
5. Auto-antonyms	Same word, opposite meanings	"Dust" (remove dust OR add dust), "Cleave"(stick-or split)

Long Question 3: Differentiate between Semantic Specification and Syntactic Specification.

Answer:

Semantic Specification	Syntactic Specification
Deals with MEANING	Deals with STRUCTURE
Explains what words mean	Explains how words are arranged
Example: "Dog" means a four-legged animal	Example: Adjectives come before nouns (big dog)

Semantic Specification

Answers: What does this mean?

Syntactic Specification

Answers: How is this sentence built?

Example Sentence: "The cat chased the mouse"

- Semantic: The cat performed the action of chasing on the mouse.
 - Syntactic: Subject (The cat) + Verb (chased) + Object (the mouse)
-

Long Question 4: What is Entailment? Write the entailment of "Amina's brother bought three horses."

Answer:

Entailment means if Sentence A is true, then Sentence B **MUST** also be true.

100% Safe Entailments of "Amina's brother bought three horses":

1. Amina has a brother.
2. Someone bought three horses.
3. Three horses exist.

Note: Do not write "money was exchanged" because entailment only includes guaranteed information.

Long Question 5: Define Vagueness in the context of Semantics and Pragmatics.

Answer:

Vagueness means language is not clear or precise.

In Semantics:

Words have fuzzy boundaries.

- Example: "Tall" - How tall is tall? A tall child is different from a tall building.

In Pragmatics:

Meaning depends on context.

- Example: "Soon" - Could mean minutes or months.
- Example: "Around 3 o'clock" - Could be 2:55 to 3:05.

Why Vagueness is Useful:

- It gives flexibility in communication.

- It avoids being too direct or rude.
- It helps in informal conversations.

Long Question 6: Speech acts vary across cultures. Explain with the example "How fat you are!" in Indian vs British cultures.

Answer:

Speech acts are used differently across cultures.

Example: "How fat you are!"

Culture	Meaning	Reason
Indian Culture	Can be a COMPLIMENT	Shows prosperity, good life, healthy eating
British Culture	Usually RUDE and OFFENSIVE	They value thinness and see this as an insult

Conclusion: The same words can have completely different meanings in different cultures. This is why cultural pragmatics is important. We must understand the cultural context to communicate properly.

Long Question 7: Write a note on Politeness Theory (Positive and Negative Face).

Answer:

Politeness Theory was developed by Brown and Levinson. It explains how we use language to be respectful and avoid offending others.

Face is a person's public self-image.

Two Types of Face:

1. Positive Face:

- The desire to be liked, approved, and accepted.
- We support it by giving compliments.
- Example: "You did a great job!"

2. Negative Face:

- The desire to be free, independent, and not imposed upon.
- We respect it by being indirect.
- Example: "Could I ask you a small favor?"

Face Threatening Acts (FTA):

- Actions that hurt someone's face.
- Examples: Criticizing, ordering, interrupting.

Face Saving Acts (FSA):

- Actions that protect someone's face.
- Examples: Apologizing, being indirect.

Example:

- Direct (threatening): "Give me salt."
- Polite (saving): "Could you please pass the salt?"

Long Question 8: What are the types of Speech Acts by John Searle?**Answer:**

John Searle classified speech acts into five categories:

Type	Purpose	Example
1. Assertives	State facts	"The sky is blue."
2. Directives	Get others to do something	"Please close the door."
3. Commissives	Promise future action	"I will help you."
4. Expressives	Show feelings	"I'm sorry." / "Congratulations!"
5. Declarations	Change reality	"I now pronounce you husband and wife."

Long Question 9: Meronyms vary in three ways. Explain with two examples.**Answer:**

Meronyms show a part-whole relationship. For example, wheel is a meronym of car.

Three ways meronyms vary:

1. Obligatoriness:
 - Is the part essential?

- Example: Hand is essential for person.
 - Example: Wheel is essential for car.
 - 2. Composition:
 - How many parts are there?
 - Example: Car has wheel, engine, door, seat.
 - Example: Tree has branch, leaf, root, trunk.
 - 3. Granularity:
 - How detailed is the description?
 - Example: Body has arm (basic) OR arm, hand, finger, nail (detailed).
 - Example: House has room (basic) OR room, wall, floor, ceiling (detailed).
-

Long Question 10: Explain Clark's Theory (Common Ground).

Answer:

Herbert Clark's theory says that successful communication depends on Common Ground. Common ground is the shared knowledge between the speaker and the listener.

Types of Common Ground:

1. Personal Knowledge:
 - Shared experiences, family, friends.
 - Example: Both people know the same teacher.
2. Cultural Knowledge:
 - Shared community knowledge.
 - Example: Both know the same cultural traditions.
3. Expert Knowledge:
 - Shared specialized information.
 - Example: Both are doctors and understand medical terms.

Example:

- If both people know the teacher, you can say "the teacher" and they will understand who you mean.
- If you are talking to a stranger, you must explain more.

Clark says: Conversation is a joint activity where both people work together to understand each other.

Long Question 11: Explain Formal Pragmatics.

Answer:

Formal pragmatics uses mathematical and logical tools to study meaning in context. It is very precise and scientific.

Features of Formal Pragmatics:

- Uses formulas and symbols.
- Studies how context affects truth conditions.
- Very systematic and logical.

Example: "She is here."

- Formal pragmatics would analyze:
 - "She" = a specific person in the context.
 - "Here" = the current location of the speaker.
 - The truth of the sentence depends on these contextual facts.

Long Question 12: What is Topic and Comment?

Answer:

- Topic = The part of the sentence that is already known (given information).
- Comment = The new information about the topic.

Examples:

1. "The movie (topic) was great (comment)."
2. "My brother (topic) lives in Lahore (comment)."
3. "The book (topic) is very interesting (comment)."

Importance: Topic and comment help make conversations flow naturally. We start with what is known and then add new information.

Long Question 13: Explain Presupposition with examples.

Answer:

Presupposition is something that the speaker assumes is true before speaking.

Examples:

Sentence

Presupposition

"My sister is a doctor."

I have a sister.

"Stop smoking!"

You were smoking.

"Again he is late!"

He was late before.

"The king of France is bald."

There is a king of France.

"She has stopped crying."

She was crying before.

Key Point: Presuppositions stay true even if we say the negative form.

- "My sister is NOT a doctor" still presupposes: I have a sister.

Long Question 14: What is Strong and Weak Implicature?

Answer:

Type	Meaning	Example
Strong Implicature	Almost certain, unavoidable	Person A: "Are you coming?" Person B: "I have work." → Implies B is NOT coming (very strong).
Weak Implicature	Possible but not certain	Person A: "Did you like the food?" Person B: "It was interesting." → Maybe liked it, maybe not (weak).

Long Question 15: What are Adjacency Pairs?

Answer:

Adjacency pairs are two-part exchanges in conversation where the second part is expected after the first.

Common Adjacency Pairs:

First Part Expected Second Part

Question Answer

Greeting Greeting

Offer Accept or Refuse

Apology Acceptance

Request Grant or Deny

Example:

- A: "Hello!" (Greeting)
- B: "Hello!" (Return greeting)

Example:

- A: "Can you help me?" (Request)
- B: "Yes, of course." (Grant)

Long Question 16: Ways of expressing speech acts vary culture to culture. Explain.

Answer:

Every culture has different ways of making requests, apologizing, refusing, and expressing feelings.

Examples:

Speech Act	British Culture	Japanese Culture	Pakistani Culture
Refusing	"I'll think about it." (indirect)	"It's difficult." (very indirect)	"Let's see." (polite indirect)
Apologizing	"I'm terribly sorry."	"Sumimasen." (frequent)	"Maaf karna." (formal)

Speech Act	British Culture	Japanese Culture	Pakistani Culture
Making a Request	"Could you possibly...?"	"If you don't mind..."	"Zara..." (soft)
Complimenting	Subtle, modest	Self-deprecating	Warm, generous

Reason: Culture shapes what is considered polite, appropriate, and normal. What is acceptable in one culture may be offensive in another.

Long Question 17: What is Training Pragmatics Outside the Classroom?

Answer:

Training pragmatics outside the classroom means learning how to use language in real-life situations, not just from textbooks.

Methods:

1. Role-plays in realistic situations.
2. Watching movies and analyzing conversations.
3. Practicing with native speakers.
4. Visiting places where the language is spoken.
5. Immersion programs.

Example: Instead of learning how to order food from a book, you actually go to a restaurant and practice ordering in real life.

Benefits:

- You learn real, natural language.
- You understand cultural context.
- You become more confident.

Long Question 18: What is the Relationship between Utterance and Prior Knowledge?

Answer:

Your prior knowledge helps you understand what someone says (utterance). Communication only works when the speaker and listener share knowledge.

Explanation:

- If you know who "the professor" is, you understand the sentence "The professor is late."
- If you don't know who the professor is, the utterance makes no sense.

Examples:

Utterance	Prior Knowledge Needed
"The president arrived."	You know who the president is.
"The Eiffel Tower is beautiful."	You know what the Eiffel Tower is.
"Let's meet at the usual place."	Both people know the place.

Conclusion: Understanding language depends on what we already know. The more shared knowledge, the better the communication.

 **WhatsApp Channel:**

<https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029VbCLoq26BIEcATBieS0t>

 **Join for Updates, Notes, Assignments & Study Support!**   